A-A-2367
October 3, 1985

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

RIBBON, COMPUTING MACHINE (WORD PROCESSING)

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description.

This commercial item description covers nylon fabric ribbon, to be used on computing machines (word processing), in continuous lengths without joining or splicing of the fabric, except as required to make endless loops, endless coreless wound ribbons, or endless cartridge ribbons.

Salient characteristics.

Weave.
The fabric shall have a regular commercial weave suitable for the purpose intended.

Edges.
Ribbon edges shall be straight and parallel with the warp threads. To prevent fraying, edges of ribbons shall be fused.

Thickness, thread count, and weight.
Ribbon thickness, thread count, and weight shall be as indicated below. ASTM D 1777 shall be used to determine thickness. Edges will not be used to determine fabric thickness.

Thickness (inches)	THREAD COUNT			Fabric weight oz. per yd.
	Total Per Sq. Inch	Warp Per Inch (min.)	Fill Per Inch (min.)	
0.0029 - 0.0035	287-302	176	111	1.25 + 3 percent
0.0034 - 0.0042	277-296	165	112	1.64 + 3 percent

Color. Ribbons shall be black.

Inking. Ribbons shall be evenly inked.

Length. Length shall be as specified and shall not be shorter than one-half inch for each yard of ribbon.

Width. Ribbon width shall be as specified. A tolerance of plus 1/64 inch and minus 0.0 inch shall be permitted, provided print quality and ribbon operation are not affected.

FSC 7510

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Spools, cartridges, and cores. Each ribbon shall be furnished on a metal or plastic spool, cartridge, core, or in a coreless configuration for the specified machine. Metal, except aluminum, shall have an enamel, lacquer, or plated finish. Each ribbon shall be designed to operate satisfactorily with the ribbon feed and reversing mechanisms of the machine specified.

Performance. When used on the designated machine model, ribbons shall produce clear, clean, and legible type impressions. There shall be no evidence of type filling. Type filling is the filling of the type face with fibers or ink from the ribbon, resulting in gradual broading or feathering of typed impression. There shall be no evidence of oil staining when ribbon impressions are examined. This performance shall be capable of being validated with a 5 hour test, at a minimum typing speed of 40 words per minute.

Workmanship. Ribbons and their spools, cartridges, or cores shall be free from all defects that will affect performance and serviceability, or present a hazard to the user. Examples of ribbon defects are uneven weave, frayed edges, slits, and knots.

Regulatory requirements. In accordance with section 23.403 of the Federal Acquisition Regulations, the Government's policy is to acquire items composed of the highest percentage of recovered materials practicable, consistent with maintaining a satisfactory level of competition without adversely affecting performance requirements or exposing suppliers' employees to undue hazards from the recovered materials.

Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking. The preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking shall be as specified in the contract or order.

NOTE. Purchasers shall indicate length, width, color, and inking (if other than specified in the CID) criteria in the procurement document.

Purchasers shall indicate the manufacturer's name and model number of the machine on which the ribbon will be used.

When this commercial item description is used for procurement, the commercial item certification clause must appear in the solicitation.

ASTM standards are available from American Society for Testing and Materials, 1916 Race Street, Philadelphia, PA. 19130.

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Custodians:

Army - GL
Navy - SA
Air Force - 99

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITY:

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

GSA - FSS

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